SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #31 · WORTH AND CLASS

“People with money are better than me.”

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Where it often comes from

Wealth often comes with confidence, polish, and access, and those can look like superiority. If we grew up with less, were treated as lesser, or were taught to defer to the wealthy, we may keep that stance for life. Media and workplaces can reinforce it by treating wealth as a measure of competence and worth.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says plainly that God does not show favoritism. Paul writes that there is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, for we are all one in Christ Jesus. James asks, “Has not God chosen those who are poor in the eyes of the world to be rich in faith?” and Paul reminds us that God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong. Before God, wealth does not rank people. We stand on level ground, with the same Maker and the same need of grace.

> *“For God does not show favoritism”* (Romans 2:11).

Also see

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

> “Listen, my beloved brothers: Has not God chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom He promised those who love Him?” (James 2:5).

> “But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong” (1 Corinthians 1:27).

> “Then Peter began to speak: ‘I now truly understand that God does not show favoritism.’” (Acts 10:34).

Common self-statements

- They are smarter than I am.
- I should defer to people with more.
- I am not in their league.
- They deserve more respect.
- I am less because I have less.
- I should not speak up around them.

Common logical errors

- Social comparison: Measuring my worth against someone’s wealth.
- Halo effect: Assuming that wealth means they are better in every way.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling small and concluding that I am small.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing people as either high or low.

Challenging questions

- What do I actually know about this person beyond their income?
- Where did I learn to rank people by money?
- What does God say about how He sees rich and poor?
- What strengths and gifts do I have that money cannot buy?

- How do I behave when I believe someone is “better” than me?
- What would it look like to treat wealthy people as equals?

Truth summary

> God does not rank people by money. I am made in His image and loved by Him as much as anyone. I can respect others without bowing to them and can stand on the level ground Christ gives.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice
- Worldly
- Pride
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God’s loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People with money are better than me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People with money are better than me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn to rank people by money?
- ☐ What gifts do I bring?
- ☐ How does God see rich and poor?
- ☐ How do I act when I feel "less than"?
- ☐ What would equal footing look like?
- ☐ What is one fact that corrects this belief?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God shows no favoritism.
- ☐ Money does not make a person better.
- ☐ I am one in Christ with everyone.
- ☐ I have gifts money cannot buy.
- ☐ I can respect people without shrinking.
- ☐ I stand on level ground before God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 2:11
  "For God does not show favoritism."
- ☐ Galatians 3:28
  "There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ James 2:5
  "Listen, my beloved brothers: Has not God chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom He promised those who love Him?"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Level ground: Each week, write one situation in which you felt "less than" and one fact that corrects it.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Galatians 3:28 becomes: "Sarah can write: "We are all one in Christ, so I stand on level ground.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Write your gifts. List five gifts or strengths you bring to any room.
- ☐ Practice equal eye contact. In your next conversation with someone more wealthy, hold steady eye contact and speak as an equal.
- ☐ Learn one person's story. Ask a question about their path, not just their position.
- ☐ Read Galatians 3:28 aloud. Say it each morning for a week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People with money are better than me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment on level ground
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People with money are better than me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You show no favoritism. Free me from believing that people with money are better than I am. Help me see myself and others as You do, and to stand with humble confidence. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.